

RRB NTPC & SSC CGL Master Practice Set

Highly Predictive Previous Year Questions (PYQs) with In-Depth Solutions

Chapter: Prehistoric Period

Exam Source: SSC CGL Tier-1 (2022)

Q1. In the context of Chalcolithic cultures of India, the prominent site of Inamgaon, which exhibits large fortified houses, a massive granary, a defensive moat, and unique intra-house floor burials, belongs to which regional culture?

- (A) Kayatha Culture
- (B) Malwa Culture
- (C) Jorwe Culture
- (D) Ahar-Banas Culture

Correct Answer: (C) Jorwe Culture

Deep-Dive Rationale: Inamgaon (located in Maharashtra) is one of the most intensively excavated settlements of the **Jorwe Culture** (circa 1400–700 BCE). It showcases an advanced proto-urban phase with complex social stratification, distinct from smaller contemporary farming villages. *Kayatha Culture* represents the earliest Chalcolithic phase in Madhya Pradesh; *Malwa Culture* is famous for its high-grade painted pottery; *Ahar-Banas Culture* is located in Rajasthan and relies heavily on copper metallurgy.

Chapter: Indus Valley Civilization (IVC)

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-2 (2022)

Q2. At which of the following Harappan sites did archaeologists uncover a massive open-ground stadium with tiered spectator seating and a unique corporate signboard containing 10 large characters of the Harappan script?

- (A) Rakhigarhi
- (B) Banawali
- (C) Dholavira
- (D) Mitathal

Correct Answer: (C) Dholavira

Deep-Dive Rationale: Dholavira in the Rann of Kutch (Gujarat) yielded a large open public area identified as a **stadium** with stone-cut steps for spectators. Additionally, a large inscription consisting of 10 symbols made from gypsum pieces—often called the *Dholavira Signboard*—was discovered near its citadel gate. *Rakhigarhi* (Haryana) is currently recognized as the largest geographical Harappan site but lacks this specific signboard; *Banawali* is famous for terracotta toy ploughs.

Chapter: The Vedic Period

Exam Source: SSC CGL Tier-2 (2023)

Q3. During the Later Vedic Period, as the state apparatus expanded, specialized royal officers called *Ratnins* emerged. What was the exact administrative function of the officer designated as Bhagadugha?

- (A) The Royal Treasurer
- (B) The Collector of Taxes and Revenue
- (C) The Chief Charioteer and Chronicler
- (D) The Superintendent of Gambling and Dice Games

Correct Answer: (B) The Collector of Taxes and Revenue

Deep-Dive Rationale: In Later Vedic polity, the **Bhagadugha** was a vital official responsible for collecting the king's share (*Bhaga*) of agricultural produce and livestock taxes. The Royal Treasurer was known as the *Sangrihitri*; the Charioteer was called the *Suta*; the Superintendent of the royal dice game was known as the *Akshavapa*.

Chapter: The Gupta Empire

Exam Source: SSC CGL Tier-1 (2022)

Q4. In the epigraphic and agrarian records of the Gupta Empire, the technical Sanskrit term 'Aprahata' was explicitly used to classify which category of land?

- (A) Cultivable agricultural land (*Kshetra*)
- (B) Habitable residential land (*Vasti*)
- (C) Waste, uncultivated, or wild forest land
- (D) Artificially irrigated pastoral grazing land

Correct Answer: (C) Waste, uncultivated, or wild forest land

Deep-Dive Rationale: Gupta land charters categorized land into five clear groups: *Kshetra* (cultivable), *Vasti* (habitable), *Khila* (wasteland), *Gopata Sarah* (pasture), and **Aprahata** (uncultivated forest or wild land).

Chapter: The Gupta Empire

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-1 (2021)

Q5. The earliest definitive, dated inscriptional record proving the historical practice of Sati in ancient India (engraved in 510 CE during the reign of Bhanugupta) was discovered at:

- (A) Junagadh, Gujarat
- (B) Eran, Madhya Pradesh
- (C) Aihole, Karnataka
- (D) Mandsaur, Madhya Pradesh

Correct Answer: (B) Eran, Madhya Pradesh

Deep-Dive Rationale: The **Eran Pillar Inscription of Bhanugupta** (510 CE) explicitly states that Goparaja, a general of the king, died in a fierce battle against foreign Huna invaders, and his wife subsequently cremated herself on his funeral pyre. *Junagadh* records the repair of the Sudarshana Lake; *Aihole* tracks Chalukya King Pulakeshin II's military victory over Harshavardhana.

Chapter: India & its Location - Frontiers

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-1 (2021)

Q6. The Nine Degree Channel establishes a distinct maritime boundary line separating which of the following geographical features in the Arabian Sea?

- (A) Car Nicobar from Great Nicobar
- (B) The Maldives Republic from Minicoy Island
- (C) Minicoy Island from the main Lakshadweep archipelago
- (D) Little Andaman from South Andaman

Correct Answer: (C) Minicoy Island from the main Lakshadweep archipelago

Deep-Dive Rationale: The **Nine Degree Channel** (9° N latitude) physically divides the southernmost island of **Minicoy** from the rest of the northern Lakshadweep islands (like Kalpeni, Kavaratti). The *Eight Degree Channel* separates Minicoy from the Maldives; the *Ten Degree Channel* separates the Andaman group from the Nicobar group.

Chapter: India & its Location - Land Borders

Exam Source: SSC CGL Tier-1 (2023)

Q7. India shares a 1,643 km long international land frontier with Myanmar. Which of the following represents the correct descending order of Indian states based on the length of the border they share with Myanmar?

- (A) Arunachal Pradesh > Mizoram > Manipur > Nagaland
- (B) Mizoram > Arunachal Pradesh > Nagaland > Manipur
- (C) Arunachal Pradesh > Manipur > Mizoram > Nagaland
- (D) Mizoram > Manipur > Nagaland > Arunachal Pradesh

Correct Answer: (A) Arunachal Pradesh > Mizoram > Manipur > Nagaland

Deep-Dive Rationale: Four states border Myanmar. The precise state-wise border distribution is: **Arunachal Pradesh** (520 km), **Mizoram** (510 km), **Manipur** (398 km), and **Nagaland** (215 km).

Chapter: The Himalayan Range

Exam Source: SSC CGL Tier-2 (2022)

Q8. Geologically, which prominent structural fault zone marks the immediate boundary separating the Trans-Himalayan system from the Great Himalayan range (Himadri)?

- (A) Main Boundary Thrust (MBT)
- (B) Indus-Tsangpo Suture Zone (ITSZ)
- (C) Main Central Thrust (MCT)
- (D) Himalayan Frontal Fault (HFF)

Correct Answer: (B) Indus-Tsangpo Suture Zone (ITSZ)

Deep-Dive Rationale: The **ITSZ** represents the structural compression zone where the Indian tectonic plate collided with and subducted under the massive Eurasian plate, marking the line of demarcation between the older Trans-Himalayas and the rising Great Himalayas. **MCT** separates the Great Himalayas from the Lesser Himalayas; **MBT** separates the Lesser Himalayas from the outer Shiwaliks.

Chapter: The Himalayan Range - Spatial Layout

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-2 (2022)

Q9. Arrange the following prominent Himalayan mountain peaks in the correct spatial sequence from West to East:

- 1. Nanda Devi**
- 2. Kanchenjunga**
- 3. Namcha Barwa**
- 4. Dhaulagiri**

- (A) 1 — 4 — 2 — 3
- (B) 4 — 1 — 2 — 3
- (C) 1 — 2 — 4 — 3
- (D) 4 — 2 — 1 — 3

Correct Answer: (A) 1 — 4 — 2 — 3

Deep-Dive Rationale: Mapping the peaks longitudinally from West to East: 1. **Nanda Devi** (Uttarakhand, India), 2. **Dhaulagiri** (Central Nepal), 3. **Kanchenjunga** (Sikkim/Nepal border), 4. **Namcha Barwa** (Eastern syntaxial bend near Tibet).

Chapter: India & its Location - Coordinates

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-1 (2016) / Repeated in SSC CGL (2021)

Q10. The Indian Standard Time (IST) meridian (82°30' E) serves as the basis for calculating uniform time across India. Through which of the following groups of five Indian states does this meridian pass?

- (A) Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh
- (B) Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Odisha
- (C) Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh
- (D) Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha

Correct Answer: (A) Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh

Deep-Dive Rationale: The 82.5° E longitude passes exactly through 5 states: **Uttar Pradesh** (near Mirzapur), **Madhya Pradesh**, **Chhattisgarh**, **Odisha**, and **Andhra Pradesh**. The meridian does not cross Bihar, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Maharashtra, Telangana, or Uttarakhand.